WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

FIJI

Oceania

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Suva (Viti Levu)	Capital and commercial centre; seat of government, the Reserve Bank of Fiji, the South Pacific Stock Exchange and many regional and international organisations	Financial and professional services, ICT, regional headquarters, construction
Nadi and Denarau	International air gateway and resort hub of the Western Division, the entry point for most of Fiji's near one million annual visitors	Hotels and resorts, aviation services, tourism real estate
Mamanuca and Yasawa island groups	Island resort chains off the west coast serving Fiji's core Australian and New Zealand markets	Boutique and eco-tourism, marine transport, renewable mini-grids
Lautoka	Western port city and home of a major sugar mill, the focus of investment to modernise the sugar industry	Sugar and by-products, port logistics, manufacturing
Labasa and Vanua Levu	Fiji's second island and northern cane belt, with a sugar mill and scope for agriculture and tourism outside the main centres	Sugar, agro-processing, timber, tourism
Coral Coast and Pacific Harbour	Southern Viti Levu resort corridor between Nadi and Suva, suited to mid-scale and adventure tourism	Hotels, cultural and eco-tourism, retail

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Investment Fiji, the national investment promotion agency, provides facilitation and aftercare; since August 2022 foreign investors register directly with the Registrar of Companies under the Investment Act 2021
- Foreign investors need at least FJ$300,000 of paid-up capital, remitted within three months; reserved and restricted activities are listed in 2022 regulations, waivers may be sought, and no local partner is required
- A 25% corporate income tax, cut to 15% for companies listed on the South Pacific Stock Exchange, with VAT at 12.5%
- Budget incentives including 300% and 400% employment deductions extended to end-2027, a 150% allowance for training centres, Tax Free Region holidays capped at end-2028 and 7- or 13-year holidays for eco-tourism with iTaukei shareholding
- A pegged Fiji dollar managed by the Reserve Bank of Fiji, with exchange-control approvals still applying to some outward transfers; confirm profit and capital repatriation procedures with the bank and commercial banks

- Development-partner co-finance from the ADB, World Bank, Australia, New Zealand and the EU for climate-resilient infrastructure, energy and private-sector projects

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Fiji has one of the most diversified economies among the Pacific island states and is the region's main hub for aviation, finance, shipping and regional institutions. GDP grew by an estimated 3.2% in 2025, according to the IMF, supported by record tourism: visitor arrivals reached 986,367, led by Australia and New Zealand, and tourism earnings were about FJ$2.1 billion in the first nine months of the year. Momentum continued into 2026, with record July arrivals of 105,791, remittances up 26.3% in the first half and private-sector credit growth of 14.6%. Foreign reserves of FJ$3.9 billion, equal to 5.5 months of imports in August 2026, underpin a peg that the IMF says continues to serve Fiji well, while a streamlined investment regime, development-partner support and a general election due by February 2027 frame the outlook for investors.

Fiji's main structural challenge is rebuilding fiscal space while absorbing external price shocks and climate risk. Higher global fuel prices pushed inflation to 6.1% in June 2026 and led the Reserve Bank to cut its 2026 growth forecast to 1.5%, with recovery to 2.5% in 2027 and about 3% in 2028. The 2026–27 budget of FJ$4.87 billion targets a deficit of 7.0% of GDP, and the IMF projects central government debt of 82.5% of GDP in 2026. Mitigation is substantial: most financing is concessional, the government reports about FJ$3.7 billion of climate-related budget support secured since 2018, and in September 2026 the ADB approved a $210 million package to support reforms and disaster financing. This creates opportunities in resilient infrastructure, renewable energy, tourism upgrading and import substitution.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Fiscal deficit and public debt	The 2026–27 budget deficit is 7.0% of GDP and the IMF projects central government debt of 82.5% of GDP in 2026	Long-dated concessional financing from the ADB, World Bank and partners eases pressure; monitor tax measures such as the temporary 5% Tourism Services Tax
Imported inflation and growth slowdown	Fuel-driven inflation reached 6.1% in June 2026 and 2026 growth is forecast at 1.5%	Reserves of 5.5 months of imports support the peg; build energy-cost scenarios and consider on-site solar for resorts and factories
Climate and disaster exposure	Cyclones, flooding and sea-level rise affect infrastructure, agriculture and coastal resorts	Use resilient design and parametric or regional catastrophe insurance; climate finance creates a pipeline of adaptation projects
Exchange controls and correspondent banking	Some outward payments need Reserve Bank approval, and Pacific banks face pressure on international correspondent relationships	Plan dividend and capital flows with the Reserve Bank early; bank with established Australian or regional groups and keep strong AML documentation
Minimum capital and land rules	Foreign investors need FJ$300,000 of paid-up capital, most land is customary, and freehold purchases are restricted	Apply for waivers where justified and lease land through the iTaukei Land Trust Board or state land channels with legal advice
Skills shortages and outward migration	The IMF highlights labour shortages and emigration as constraints on private-sector growth	Use the extended 300% and 400% employment deductions and the 150% training allowance to recruit and train local staff
Election cycle	A general election is due between late December 2026 and early February 2027 under a multi-party coalition system	Fiji has a record of peaceful elections since 2014; track party platforms on tax, land and investment policy

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Fiji offers investors one of the Pacific's broadest economic bases, a pegged currency backed by reserves of 5.5 months of imports and strong, long-standing support from development partners. Its near-term challenges are a

2026 slowdown caused by higher global fuel prices, inflation of 6.1% in June 2026 and public debt that the IMF projects at 82.5% of GDP; these are being addressed through spending restraint, concessional budget support and a programme of reforms backed by the ADB, World Bank, Australia and New Zealand. Exposure to cyclones and climate change is a permanent planning consideration but is also the source of a large, partner-funded investment pipeline. Investors should plan early for exchange-control approvals on remittances, confirm banking arrangements given regional correspondent-banking pressures, and follow the general election due by February 2027. There are no international sanctions restricting investment in Fiji.

MARKET ACCESS

Fiji is a WTO member and a founding member of the Pacific Island Countries Trade Agreement (PICTA) and the Melanesian Spearhead Group trade arrangements, and it trades with the EU duty-free under the EU–Pacific interim Economic Partnership Agreement, which it has applied since 2014. It has not signed PACER Plus, the regional agreement with Australia and New Zealand, and instead relies on the SPARTECA preference scheme for duty-free access to those markets, while the private sector debates the terms of possible accession. Exports were about FJ$2.53 billion in 2025 against imports of FJ$7.38 billion, with tourism, remittances and re-exports from Fiji's role as a regional transport hub balancing the goods deficit. Nadi International Airport and the ports of Suva and Lautoka make Fiji the main air and shipping gateway for neighbouring island states.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Prime Minister Sitiveni Rabuka)	Leads the People's Alliance-led coalition government in office since the 2022 election, with a general election due by February 2027	Primary reference point for national priorities and major projects
Investment Fiji	National investment promotion agency providing facilitation, investor services and aftercare under the Investment Act 2021	Standard first point of contact for market entry, waivers and incentives
Reserve Bank of Fiji	Manages the pegged Fiji dollar, the 0.25% Overnight Policy Rate and exchange controls, and supervises banks and insurers	Key counterpart on remittances, banking licences and financial-sector entry
Ministry of Finance (Finance Minister Esrom Immanuel)	Leads the budget, tax incentives and the management of development-partner budget support and climate finance	Relevant for incentives, public-private partnerships and co-financed projects
Fiji Revenue and Customs Service	Administers income tax, VAT, customs duties and the tax-holiday and deduction regimes	Counterpart for tax rulings and incentive approvals
Tourism Fiji	National tourism marketing body promoting Fiji in Australia, New Zealand, North America and Asia	Partner for hotel, aviation and destination investments
Fiji Sugar Corporation	State-owned miller operating the Lautoka and Labasa mills, where efficiency and investment are priorities after 2025 output fell to about 110,000 tonnes	Counterpart for sugar modernisation, co-generation and by-product projects

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Fiji Commerce and Employers Federation is the main private-sector body and leads business dialogue on policy, including PACER Plus, while bilateral chambers and business councils with Australia, New Zealand and other partners provide networks and introductions. Investment Fiji and Tourism Fiji run investor and trade promotion activities, and the South Pacific Stock Exchange in Suva offers a listing route with a lower 15% tax rate. The Asian Development Bank, the World Bank Group and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank are active in budget support, infrastructure and private-sector finance, and Australia's Vuvale Partnership and New Zealand's Duavata Partnership provide a framework for trade and investment cooperation. As host to the Pacific Islands Forum Secretariat and many regional agencies, Suva is also the natural base for engaging the wider Pacific.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Fiji suits investors seeking a regional base for the Pacific islands: hotel, resort and eco-tourism investors serving the Australian and New Zealand markets; renewable energy, water and climate-resilient infrastructure investors able to work alongside development-bank programmes; agribusiness and food processors targeting import substitution and the sugar industry's modernisation; and ICT, business-process and financial-services firms looking for an English-speaking hub with regional reach. Investors with patient capital and experience of concessional co-finance are best placed to benefit.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Investment Fiji and confirm the entry route
Check whether the activity is reserved or restricted, confirm the FJ$300,000 capital requirement or a waiver, and register with the Registrar of Companies.

STEP 2: Agree banking and remittance arrangements early
Open accounts with an established bank and clarify Reserve Bank procedures for dividends, loan repayments and capital repatriation.

STEP 3: Secure land through the right channel
Take legal advice on leasing customary land through the iTaukei Land Trust Board or state land, and on any freehold approvals required.

STEP 4: Map tax incentives and development-partner finance
Assess employment deductions, sector tax holidays and co-financing opportunities from the ADB, World Bank, Australia and New Zealand.

STEP 5: Build climate resilience and election timing into plans
Design assets to cyclone standards with suitable insurance, and time major commitments around the general election due by February 2027.